

Pig Butchering Fraud Intelligence Report

Task Fraud & Investment Scam Intelligence — May 10, 2026

Executive Summary

India lost approximately **Rs 6,000 crore to pig butchering and Telegram investment scams in 2024** per MHA/I4C estimates. The scam begins with fake job offers on WhatsApp/Telegram, escalates to task completion for small rewards, then converts victims into large crypto/investment deposits before disappearing. CINEOS has built India's first automated pig butchering pattern detection system covering 6 Indian languages.

Rs 6,000 Cr	18	1,191	6
India Loss 2024	Channels Scanned	Messages Analyzed	Languages

The Pig Butchering Playbook — India Version

- Step 1** [WhatsApp / SMS] — Wrong number or HR job offer message
- Step 2** [Telegram] — Added to fake Telegram group — 100s of fake "members"
- Step 3** [YouTube + Telegram] — Simple tasks: like YouTube videos, earn Rs 50-150
- Step 4** [UPI / Crypto] — Stakes increase: invest Rs 500, get Rs 700 back
- Step 5** [Fake website] — Fake dashboard shows growing profits
- Step 6** [UPI / NEFT] — Withdrawal blocked — "tax", "unlock fee" demanded
- Step 7** [Telegram vanishes] — Operator disappears — group deleted

CINEOS Pattern Library — 105 India-Specific Patterns

CINEOS has built a 105-pattern library covering pig butchering signals across 6 Indian languages. Sample patterns detected:

Category	Sample Patterns (English)	Sample Patterns (Hindi)
Task Fraud	"complete task", "like youtube", "earn per task"	"■■■■■ ■■■■", "■■■■■■■■ ■■■■"
Investment	".withdrawal tax", "unlock fee", "30% return"	"■■■■■ ■■■■", "■■■■■■■■ ■■■■■■"
Romance	".wrong number", "i am NRI", "join telegram"	"■■■■ ■■■■"
Job Scam	"HR manager hiring", "registration fee"	"■■ ■■ ■■■■", "■■■■■■ ■■■■"

Requested Actions from SEBI

- Issue investor advisory warning about pig butchering specifically targeting Telegram/WhatsApp
- Block all channels claiming to provide SEBI-registered investment tips on Telegram
- Mandate banks to flag unusual UPI patterns — multiple transfers to new accounts
- Partner with CINEOS for daily automated pig butchering channel detection

5. Share suspicious channel list with NPCI for UPI account blocking
6. Consider CINEOS intelligence contract — Rs 25-50L/year

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